

ENTREPRENEURIAL PULSE



E-club APIIT

apiit_eclub



FOODFEST FUN FAIR

**AS**

this month's primary project, FoodFest provided a platform for aspiring student entrepreneurs to showcase their culinary creations and business ideas to a vibrant audience. With a diverse range of stalls, including Nail Express by Shery, Tealicious, Asteria, The Ocakes, the Rotaract Club of APIIT, and the Conservatory Club of APIIT, attendees were treated to a delicious and delightful experience. FoodFest served as a launchpad for these budding entrepreneurs, providing valuable experience in product presentation, customer interaction, and navigating a real-world market environment and also served as the first fair for the current year.



The event drew a massive crowd, transforming the L5 outdoor area in City Campus into a bustling marketplace from 12PM onwards. Attendees enjoyed delicious food, fun music, and exciting games, creating a vibrant and enjoyable atmosphere. We'd like to extend a special congratulations to Sheraya Samaranayake, owner of Nail Express by Sherry, for winning the coveted Rs. 10,000 cash prize! Chaired by Vice President Amany Ekanayake, FoodFest truly helped in cultivating the spirit of entrepreneurship under the banner of Entrepreneurial Skills, which is the basis of our club's existence here at APIIT thus helping us hit a significant milestone.



The APIIT Entrepreneurship Club is grateful to all the talented vendors who participated, showcasing their passion and dedication. A sincere thank you to everyone who attended and supported this phenomenal event. FoodFest stands as a testament to the thriving spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship within the APIIT community. We look forward to hosting more fairs that empower and inspire our student entrepreneurs to have successful ventures!



Coffee Chats wasn't just about the speaker. It fostered a vibrant community atmosphere. The event space buzzed with conversation as students connected, exchanged ideas, and built valuable networks. The APIIT Entrepreneurship Club provided an environment where aspiring entrepreneurs felt empowered and supported – a crucial element for their future success. Chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera and Head of Media Keshiny Sritharan, CoffeeChats was truly a one of a kind event. With a future series of events themed around CoffeeChats imminent, we look forward to hosting more creative and successful events featuring insightful entrepreneurs.



The overwhelming positive response to Coffee Chats is a testament to the thriving spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship within the APIIT community. The Entrepreneurship Club Of APIIT Colombo extends its gratitude to Mr. Dilupa Pathirana for sharing his expertise and to all the attendees for their enthusiastic participation. Coffee Chats served as a launchpad for future events, and the club is committed to providing students with the resources and inspiration they need to turn their ambitious dreams into reality.



COFFEE CHATS



The APIIT Entrepreneurship Club proudly hosted a resounding success – Coffee Chats, a dynamic session featuring Mr. Dilupa Pathirana, the CEO of Barista Sri Lanka. Held on the 17th of July, 2024 at the Auditorium in City Campus premises, the event drew a vibrant and eager crowd of aspiring students and potential future entrepreneurs hungry for knowledge and inspiration. Mr. Pathirana's insightful presentation delved into the secrets of building a successful brand in the Sri Lankan cafe industry. He shared valuable lessons on leadership, innovation, and the power of turning passion into a thriving business. Couple with a QnA session, CoffeeChats aimed to provide a platform for engagement.



Thariq, Amaya Fonseka, Ranudi Abeysekera and Harivthushanan Sasendran, the overall team consists of Reema Shiyam as secretary, Craleeth Gunathilika, Minodya Ranwala, Sanindee Serasinghe, Rachel De Silva, Hesalni Danthanarayanan, Radhesh Zureshkumar, Sulaiya Fawaz, Yuneth Gunathilake, Duloky Vithanage, Udyia Illukthanna, Miyuni Dangampala, Aakifah Riyaadh, Lihini Witharana and Tihara Sanulya. We wish the committee best of luck with this upcoming venture!



SANDBOX COMMITTEE

WHAT IS SANDBOX

IT is with great pleasure and enthusiasm that the Entrepreneurship Club reveals the highly dedicated and motivated individuals serving on the external committee for our biggest project, Sand-box. Chaired by the Vice President, Kavindu Wannisinghe, Treasurer Himidiri Samintha and President Vidussh Gunasekera, the team comprises of an overall committee of 27 members. With marketing, media, logistics, communications and IT led by Piyumiji Dangalla, Umar Hakeem, Shevan Gomis, Rimzana Basheer, Devon Bastianz, Thahnees

UPCOMING EVENTS

PHOTOPRENEUR



Photopreneur will be an exciting upcoming project taking place in August 2024, organized by the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT Colombo on empowering entrepreneurship through photography

and sustainability. The project will see a call for photographs to be submitted on the theme of sustainability and nature which will culminate to an exhibition where you will have your cinematic captures displayed. Photopreneur will see the Entrepreneurship Club partnering with

external organizations for potential partnerships who will play a role in the judging process. The photo that stands out as the best will win a grand prize from an organization operating in the photography field. Submissions opening soon! Stay tuned. Submission guidelines, rules and regulations and judging guidelines will be publicized by the club soon. Login to eclub.apiit.lk to find our more and stay tuned for more upcoming projects.



STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

AMRA ASKAR

BUSINESS PROFILE:

Asteria is an affordable jewelry brand celebrated for its unique designs. If you're seeking high-quality jewelry without breaking the bank, Asteria is the perfect choice. The brand offers a range of beautifully crafted pieces, ensuring that you can find something special that suits your style.

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

·My entrepreneurial spirit was sparked by a passion for creativity. I came up with the idea for my jewelry business- Asteria as a way to generate the necessary capital to fund my future café. Asteria provides a solid foundation and financial support allowing me to refine my entrepreneurial skills, understand market dynamics, and build a loyal customer base to achieve my long-term goal.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

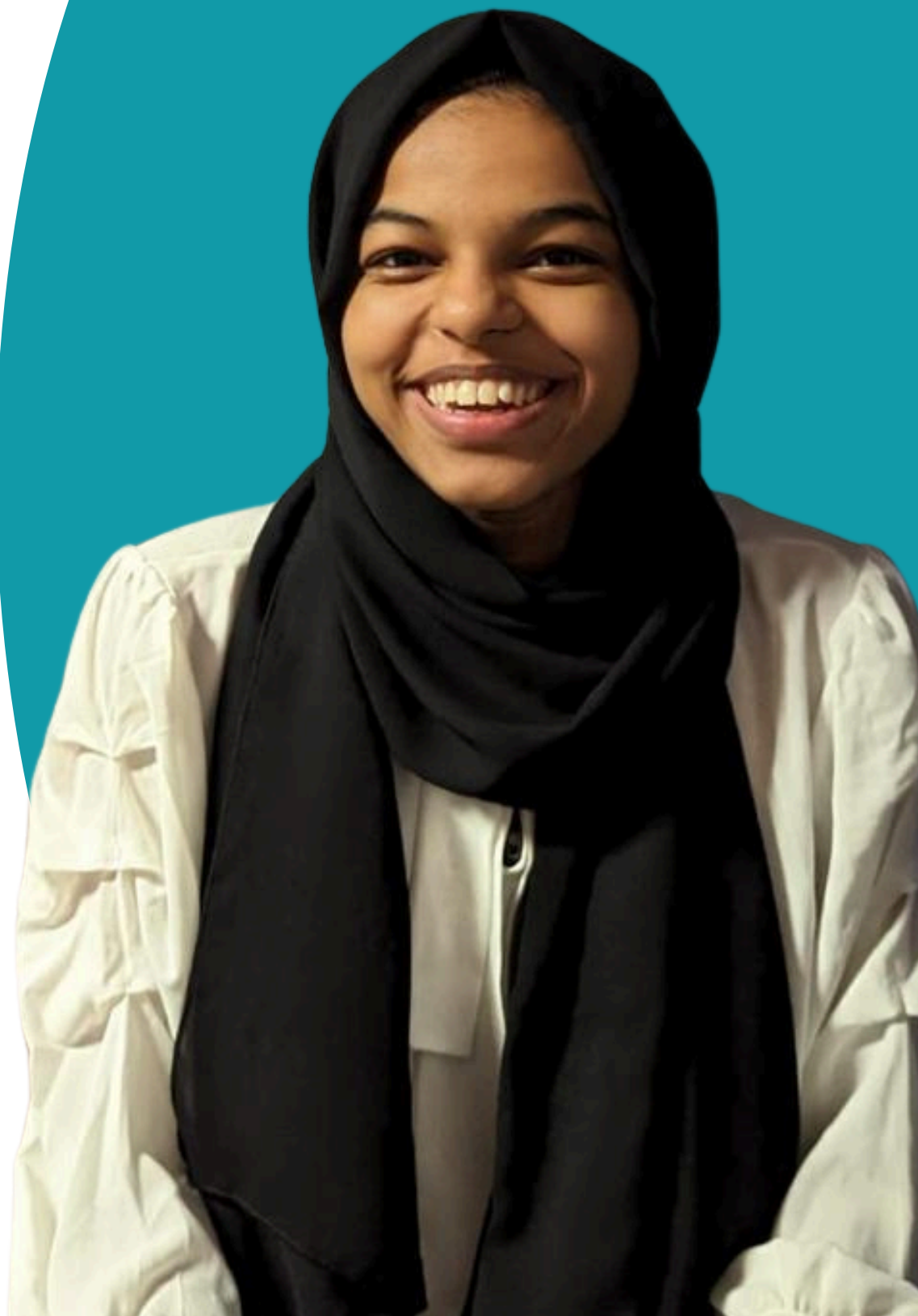
·The biggest challenges I've faced so far in my jewelry business have been financial constraints and building a loyal customer base. Starting with limited capital made it difficult to invest in high-quality materials and marketing efforts, which are essential for growing a business. Additionally, in a competitive market, establishing a loyal customer base has been a challenge.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

It allows me the freedom to pursue my passions and bring my creative visions to life. Being my own boss gives me the flexibility to make decisions that align with my values and goals. It allows me to innovate, experiment, and adapt. Moreover, this venture is a stepping stone towards my long-term goal of opening a café.



ASTERIA



4. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

As a student entrepreneur, social media and Meta Business Suite have been incredibly valuable resources. Meta Business Suite, in particular, has been a game-changer by enabling me to plan and schedule posts in advance. This feature helps me manage my time more efficiently.

5. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

I market my jewelry business primarily through social media and events like pop-ups. Social media platforms have been instrumental in reaching my target audience by showcasing my designs, engaging with potential customers, and running targeted ads. This helps build brand awareness and drive traffic to my business. Additionally, participating in pop-up events allows me to connect with customers in person, provide a tangible experience of my products, and gather direct feedback. These strategies have been effective in building a loyal customer base and increasing visibility for my jewelry business.

6. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope my jewelry business will make a meaningful impact by offering unique, high-quality pieces that bring joy to my customers and reflect my passion for creativity. In 5-10 years, I envision my business thriving and well-established, with a strong reputation and a loyal customer base. I aim to expand my product line and possibly open a physical store that reflects the essence of my brand. Additionally, my long-term goal is to use the capital and experience gained from my jewelry business to open a café, where customers can enjoy a warm, inviting atmosphere complemented by my jewelry designs.

8. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

My top piece of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs is: First, embrace failure as a learning opportunity. Second, stay adaptable in a rapidly changing world. And third, always prioritize customer satisfaction—it's the key to sustainable growth. What keeps me motivated? Seeing my vision slowly take shape and knowing that every setback is a stepping stone to success.

9. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey?

Yes, I've been fortunate to have the support of my friends, family, and, most importantly, my best friend, who has been a tremendous source of encouragement and advice throughout my journey. For other students seeking mentorship, I would advise reaching out to individuals who genuinely care about your success and have experience in your field of interest.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired? What keeps you motivated and inspired?

My top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs are: don't lose hope, trust the process, and keep working towards your end goal. Stay focused on your long-term objectives and embrace the journey, even when faced with setbacks. What keeps me motivated and inspired is the progress I see from my hard work and the support from my friends, family, and best friend.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

Looking back, I wouldn't change a thing. I'm proud of starting my entrepreneurial journey early and using my own capital to fund it. This experience has been incredibly rewarding, teaching me valuable lessons and allowing me to grow both personally and professionally. What I've enjoyed most about this journey is the sense of accomplishment that comes from seeing my ideas come to life.

ROLLERCOASTER RIDE TOWARDS SUCCESS

BY AMANYA EKANAYAKE



Hey there, aspiring young entrepreneurs! Are you ready to hop on a thrilling rollercoaster ride towards success? Well, buckle up, because the entrepreneurial journey is about to take you on the wildest, most exhilarating adventure of your life! In this article, we'll explore the ups, downs, twists, and turns that make being a young entrepreneur so incredibly fun and rewarding.

The Crazy Loop of Success

Picture this: You're sitting in your room, and suddenly, a brilliant idea strikes you like lightning! Your heart starts racing, and you can't wait to unleash your entrepreneurial genius onto the world. But here's the thing ideas are like roller coaster loops. They come and go, but the key is to capture them when they're at their peak. So carry a notebook or use a fancy note-taking app to catch those thrilling loops of inspiration!

The Lofty Climbs of Determination

Now that you have your idea locked and loaded, it's time to embark on the journey. Just like a roller coaster, there will be moments when you climb to great heights of determination. You'll face challenges, setbacks, and naysayers who think your idea won't fly. But don't let them rain on your parade! Hold on tight, summon your inner determination, and push forward fearlessly. Remember, the steeper the climb, the more incredible the drop!



The Heart Stopping Drops of Risk

Here comes the most thrilling part – the heart-stopping drops of risk! As a young entrepreneur, you'll be faced with decisions that make your stomach churn and your palms sweaty.

Taking calculated risks is what separates the true entrepreneurs from the rest. Embrace the adrenaline rush, trust your instincts, and take that leap of faith. Who knows? The biggest drop might just lead you to the greatest rewards!

The Twists and Turns of Adaptability

Just when you think you have it all figured out, the entrepreneurial roller coaster throws you a curveball. Suddenly, the market changes, new technologies emerge, and customer preferences shift. But fear not! The key to staying on track is adaptability. Embrace the twists and turns, pivot when necessary, and keep your eyes open for opportunities that might surprise you around the next corner.



The Exhilarating Highs of Success

After enduring the loops, climbs, drops, and turns, there's nothing quite like the euphoria of reaching the pinnacle of success. The hard work, sleepless nights, After and countless cups of coffee finally pay off. Celebrate your achievements, but don't forget that success is just another part of the ride. Take a moment to enjoy the view from the top, but be ready for the next thrilling adventure that awaits!

So, dear young entrepreneurs, fasten your seatbelts and get ready for the entrepreneurial ride of a lifetime! Embrace the crazy loops of ideas, tackle the lofty climbs of determination, take heart-stopping drops of risk, navigate the twists and turns of adaptability, and savor the exhilarating highs of success.

Remember, entrepreneurship is not just about the destination; it's about the incredible journey that shapes you into the trailblazer you were meant to be. So, take a leap of faith, hold on tight, and let the roller coaster of entrepreneurship propel you towards a future of limitless possibilities!

Go forth and conquer, my entrepreneurial friends. The world is waiting for your next big adventure!

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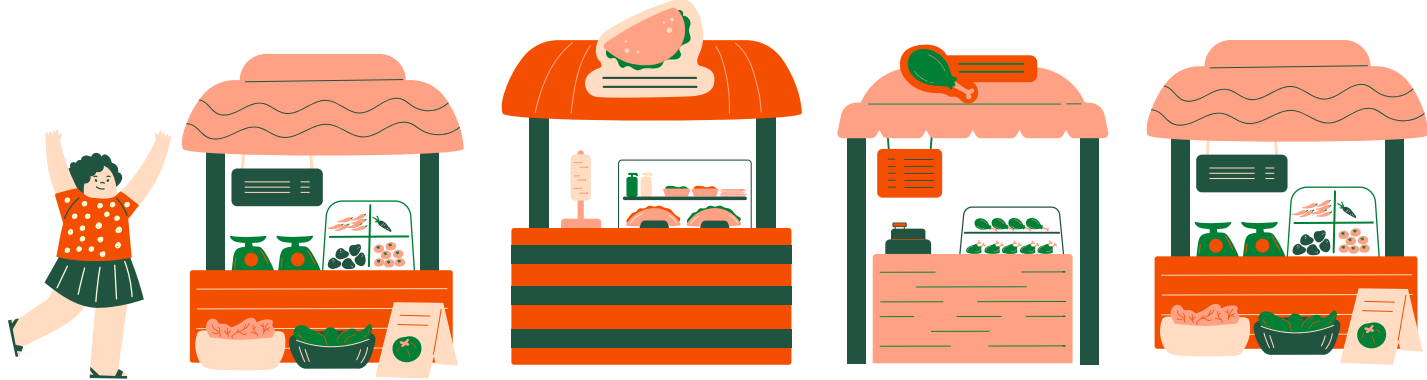


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